

# Evading a DDoS Attack

## Using *mod\_evasive*

*mod\_evasive* is an Apache module that provides evasive action in the event of an HTTP DDoS attack or brute force attack. It is also a detection and network management tool.

Let's take a quick look at how it can help organisations evade a DDoS attack.



A Denial-of-Service (DoS) attack is one that is initiated by malicious actors to render a service connected to the Internet unavailable for legitimate users. This is typically achieved by flooding the target system with requests that consume all the bandwidth and overload the computing resources, thereby making the serving of requests slow or even entirely impossible.

A DDoS is a distributed type of the Denial-of-Service attack that uses multiple sources to mount an attack.

This makes it difficult to stop such attacks by blocking the source IP address, a move that would otherwise work well for a Denial-of-Service attack. At times, the attack may not even target a service directly but, instead, target the auxiliary services such as DNS services, in order to prevent access.

One thing that holds true with any form of DDoS attack is that it not only compromises the user experience of your website, but can also cause financial losses in terms of

compute wastage, additional bandwidth costs and administrative overhead to keep the services up and running.

A DDoS requires a network of devices that can be used to launch attacks. A common way of acquiring such networks is by hijacking smart connected devices, such as routers and IoT devices exposed to the Internet and using them to carry out the attacks. These networks are called botnets. It should not come as a surprise that attackers gain access to most of these devices using default passwords.